

project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

YELLOW LEVEL
GRADE LEVEL

Fact-Checker Training

Grades 3–4

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

Optical illusions prove that our eyes and brains can be fooled—even when we're paying attention! Throughout history, people have used this to deceive others: from Victorian "ghost photographers" who tricked grieving families, to modern "deepfake" videos that put fake words in real people's mouths. The good news? You can learn to protect yourself.

01 PART 1 — The 5 Fact-Checker Rules

1. STOP before you share	Don't spread information just because it's exciting
2. CHECK the source	Who created this? Are they trustworthy?
3. SEARCH for more	Can you find this from other reliable sources?
4. ASK an adult	When in doubt, check with someone you trust
5. TRUST YOUR GUT	If it seems too good (or too weird) to be true, investigate more

02 PART 2 — Apply the Rules

For each scenario, write which rule(s) you would use AND explain why:

Scenario 1: A post says your favorite celebrity is coming to your town this weekend, but you've never heard of the website sharing it.

Rules I'd use: _____

Why: _____

Scenario 2: Your friend shows you a video of a politician saying something really mean. The video looks real.

Rules I'd use: _____

Why: _____

Scenario 3: You see a post saying a new video game gives you a virus. You want to warn your friends.

Rules I'd use: _____

Why: _____

PART 3

03 Create Your Own Scenario

Write a situation where someone might need to use the Fact-Checker Rules:

_____

_____

_____

Which rules would help? Why?

_____

_____

_____

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

The Mini Museum displays Victorian optical illusion cards and a stereoscope from 1904. These devices amazed people who didn't understand how they worked. Spirit photographers used similar tricks to create "ghost photos" and charged grieving families money. Understanding the trick = power to protect yourself!

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving/illusions

PART 4

04 Reflection Questions

1. Why do you think people believed the fake "ghost photos" were real back in the 1860s?

_____

_____

2. What makes it harder to spot fakes today compared to back then?

_____

_____

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Family Discussion: Ask your family about a time they saw something online that turned out to be false. How did they figure out it wasn't true?

Family Challenge: Together, find a news story and practice using the Fact-Checker Rules. Can you verify if it's true?